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Air Assault Task Unit
1st Battalion, 7th Cavalry Regiment
1st Armored Brigade Combat Team
1st Cavalry Division
172000CFEB18

OPERATIONS ORDER (OPORD):
JUNIPER SPEAR

BATTALION TO TASK UNIT OPERATIONS ORDER

REFERENCES:

(1) ***Area of Interest Overlay***

<u>Of note:</u>
Green line: PL Green
Red diagonal grid marks: Reported AA zones
Orange circles: Approximate crash locations.
Red Square: Prison encampment
Blue Square: Friendly FOB

Task Organization:

Air Assault Task Unit;
1x Infantry Rifle Platoon (Light/Air Assault)
1x Assault / General Aviation Platoon (3x UH-60)
1x FAO/ FAC (MH-6)
1x Medical Section
1x Battalion Headquarters Section

I. **Situation**.

At 1800 local time, a good portion of Misfit platoon was mobilized to act upon sightings of Ahmad Umar and a large entourage of military forces, supposedly to give a speech in order to rally the local populace against us. Misfit boarded into four UH-60 (Buffalo) and departed for Mogadishu. At 1830, Buffalo assets were ambushed upon attempting to land troops into the city, resulting in all birds being damaged heavily or destroyed.

The final communication with misfit platoon was with one low-level individual over a handheld radio, which reported that he and five others from his bird as well as those nearby were still alive and had been taken prisoner at a nearby encampment. He was cut off by yelling and machine gun fire shortly after.

A. Enemy Forces.

i. ***Weather and light data general forecast for the length of the operation***:
High Temp: 30 Celsius
Low Temp: 26 Celsius
Sunrise: 0630 Z+3
Sunset: 2200 Z+3
Overall Weather: Sunny
Illumination (Night): N/A

ii. ***Terrain (OCAKA)***:

a) **Observation and Fields of Fire (FOF)** are limited for BLUFOR due to MOUT conditions. OPFOR has barricaded all roads leading in and out

of the crash site areas and encampment, as well as garrisoned buildings and terrain surrounding it.

b) **Cover and Concealment** is optimal for OPFOR entrenched in and around the encampment and crash sites, given the MOUT environment.

c) **Obstacles** have been setup blocking the roads leading in and out of the crash sites and encampment. OPFOR may have also setup ambush points, as well as IEDs, VIEDs, and suicide bombers. There is a heavy anti air presence to the NW and W of AO with unknown AA asset presence currently in AO.

d) **Key or Decisive Terrain** for this mission is the the crash sites, which are located throughout the city of Mogadishu. The OPFOR encampment containing BLUFOR EPWs is the previous mayor of Mogadishu residence - meaning that it is already heavily fortified and has additional CSW within.

e) **Avenues of Approach** for OPFOR are from the north, in and west in the event they are able to rally and reinforce, or counterattack.

iii. ***Identification of enemy forces (composition)***. The OPFOR heavy assets that were seized from the 3rd Brigade, SNSF are stationed in and around the Military Academy and Training Camp. OPFOR is also equipped with crew served weapons, along with motorized assets.

iv. ***Location(s)***:

a) **Crash Site 1** - Grid: 1111 9501
b) **Crash Site 2** - Grid: 1095 9481
c) **Crash Site 3** - Grid: 1061 9481
d) **Crash Site 4** - Grid: 1041 9499
e) **OPFOR Encampment** - Grid: 1105 9519

v. ***Activity***: OPFOR is consolidating around the crash sites and garrisoning their positions, along with blockading likely avenues of approach. Any attempts to deploy to and secure the crash sites will likely be ambushed. OPFOR have also garrisonned the encampment with CSW.

vi. ***Strength***: OPFOR current strength estimates place it at around five hundred (500) fighters still remaining in Mogadishu, with several hundred coalescing on the crash sites. S2 estimates indicate OPFOR morale is high, despite the recent capture of three key leaders. Garrisoned fighters in the north west of the city can

reinforce the crash sites within minutes, although a quick response would not be organized.

vii. ***Probable course(s) of action when contacted***: OPFOR will likely remain in place and fight, and may attempt to counter-attack, and or make first contact through an ambush. Given high morale, if decisively engaged, they will fight to the death, and likely not to surrender.

B. Friendly Forces.

i. ***Mission and concept of next higher unit:*** The Air Assault Task Unit assigned to 1st Battalion, 7th Cavalry will secure the crash sites, recover all personnel, including WIA and KIA, then exfill them back to FOB Jazeerah.

ii. ***Location and planned actions of units to the left, right, front, and rear***: All other Battalion personnel are garrisoned at FOB Jazeerah, in support of 3rd Brigade SNSF blocking positions to the north and west of the FOB.

iii. ***Units providing fire support***:

a) Mortars: Not available.

b) CAS: Buffalos available for limited CAS and overwatch if fully crewed.

c) Artillery: Not available.

C. **Attachments/Detachments.**

i. ***Attachment***: No attachments. CBRN attachments will be available once the WMDs have been seized and secured.

ii. ***Detachment***: No detachments from BN HQ.

II. **Mission.**

The Task Unit's mission is to move into Mogadishu via Air Assault. The Task Unit will locate, secure and then destroy each crash site before hostile forces can salvage them for signals intelligence. In addition, the Task Unit will locate and extract all BLUFOR personnel, including KIA from the designated OPFOR encampment.

III. **Execution.**

The intent is to rescue all BLUFOR personnel, and to deprive the enemy of any BLUFOR assets. Additionally, deprive OPFOR of holding onto captured BLUFOR EPWs.

A. **Concept of the Operation**: The Task Unit will locate and secure each crash site. Upon reaching and securing the crash site, the Task Unit will then destroy all BLUFOR assets

(e.g. UH-60s), as well as rescue all BLUFOR personnel, including KIA (if possible). The Task Unit will then extract all survivors and bodies from the the OPFOR encampment back to FOB Jazeerah.

1. ***Maneuver***: The mission will consist of the following movements:

    a. Initial reconnaissance via Aviation assets to locate crash sites and BLUFOR.

    b. Infill Infantry at crash sites.

    c. Secure crash sites, destroy all unusable BLUFOR assets (e.g. UH-60s).

    d. Recover and secure all BLUFOR personnel at crash sites, including WIA, and KIA from OPFOR encampment.

    e. Exfill all BLUFOR personnel from area of operation back to FOB Jazeerah.

2. **Fires**: N/A

B. **Tasks to Maneuver Units.**

1. Reconnaissance will be conducted by Attack Reconnaissance, and/or Assault/General Aviation rotary assets.

2. Security and recovery of BLUFOR will be conducted by Infantry Platoon.

3. Security, R&S, EPW, Aid and Litter, and demolition will be handled by the Security Squad.

C. **Tasks to Combat Support Units.**

i. Battalion medical officer will supply in field medical support.

ii. Transport will be provided by 2-227th AVN
(Only 3 UH-60s available at this time + 1 MH-6 Observer craft)

iii. All other combat support will not be available for this mission.

D. **Coordinating Instructions**.

i. ***Order of movement, formations, and movement techniques***.

a) Buffalo Flight

Holding Area CUTLASS @ 1305-9455

LZ BROADSWORD @ 1195-9540

LZ MUSKET @ approx. 1160-9495 (will be confirmed by Apollo-6)

LZ HALBERD @ 1107-9523

All airframes: brief crews, await clearance from Pegasus-1 to mount up & perform checks. Notify Pegasus-1 when ready to receive passengers.

(1) **Buffalo-1:** Await embarking of Bandit-1 & Bandit-6 (+ Bandit medic). Depart base on heading 090 4km, then heading 360 1.5km to HA CUTLASS. Pegasus-1 will give green light for insert into LZ BROADSWORD. RTB. Await embarking of Bandit-3 & Bandit-5. Depart base on heading 090 4km, then heading 360 1.5km to HA CUTLASS. Pegasus-1 will give green light for insert into LZ BROADSWORD. RTB. Provide reinsert at LZ MUSKET as needed. Exfil will be conducted at LZ BROADSWORD.

(2) **Buffalo-2:** Await embarking of Bandit-2 & Mustang-1. Depart base on heading 090 4km, then heading 360 1.5km to HA CUTLASS. Pegasus-1 will give green light for insert into LZ BROADSWORD. RTB. Await embarking of Havoc-1, Apollo-6 & Apollo-1. Depart base on heading 090 4km, then heading 360 1.5km to HA CUTLASS. Pegasus-1 will give green light for insert into LZ BROADSWORD. RTB. Provide reinsert at LZ MUSKET as needed. Exfil will be conducted at LZ BROADSWORD.

(3) **Buffalo-3:** No passengers will embark on Buffalo-3 for initial insert. Provide security for Buffalo flight on all inserts. Pegasus-1 / Bandit-6 will send priority targets (technicals / massed infantry) to be engaged by Buffalo-3.

(4) **Pegasus-1:** Give clearance to Buffalo flight to mount up & perform checks. Notify Bandit-6 once Buffalo flight is ready to receive passengers. When Bandit Platoon is embarking, mount up in MH-6 and depart base heading 090 4km, then heading 360 1.5km to HA CUTLASS. Provide SPOTREPS to Bandit-6. Relay priority targets (technicals / massed infantry) to Buffalo-3. Give green light to buffalo flight for initial insert. Give green light to buffalo flight for secondary insert. When PRISON is secured by Bandit platoon provide MEDEVAC at LZ

HALBERD, RTB with wounded. When MEDEVAC is complete return to AO to provide surveillance for Bandit-6.

b) **Bandit Platoon** - 3x AT4 per squad (RFL / CLS / SL)

RP 1 @ 1168-9529

PRISON @ 1104-9518

CRASH SITE 1 @ 1111-9501

CRASH SITE 2 @ 1095-9482

CRASH SITE 3 @ 1061- 9481

CRASH SITE 4 @ 1039-9498

(1) **Bandit-1:** Brief squad, perform kit check and radio check. Form file facing towards airframes. Embark on Buffalo-1 when ordered by Bandit-6, for initial insert. Insert into LZ BROADSWORD. Move to RP 1 and provide security to North until second insert complete. Bandit-1 will then assault and secure CRASH SITE 1, then establish a support by fire position overwatching the PRISON. All POWs at CRASH SITE 1 will be brought to support by fire position. Bandit-3 and Havoc-1 will assault and secure the PRISON. Any POWs will receive MEDEVAC from PRISON. Platoon will move in column down ASR WHISKEY and assault CRASH SITE 3. Platoon will move north along ASR BOURBON and assault CRASH SITE 4. Platoon will return to LZ BROADSWORD for exfil.

(2) **Bandit-2:** Brief squad, perform kit check and radio check. Form file facing towards airframes. Embark on Buffalo-2 when ordered by Bandit-6, for initial insert. Insert into LZ BROADSWORD. Move to RP 1 and provide security to West until second insert complete. Bandit-2 will then assault and secure CRASH SITE 1, then establish a support by fire position overwatching the PRISON. All POWs at CRASH SITE 1 will be brought to support by fire position. Bandit-3 and Havoc-1 will assault and secure the PRISON. Any POWs will receive MEDEVAC from PRISON. Platoon will move in column down ASR WHISKEY and assault CRASH SITE 3. Platoon will move north along ASR BOURBON and assault CRASH SITE 4. Platoon will return to LZ BROADSWORD for exfil.

(3) **Bandit-3:** Brief squad, perform kit check and radio check. Form file behind Bandit-1. Embark on Buffalo-1 when ordered by Bandit-5, for secondary insert. Bandit-3 will then assault and secure CRASH SITE 2, then assault and secure the main PRISON building. Havoc-1 will secure the secondary PRISON buildings. Any POWs will receive MEDEVAC from PRISON. Platoon will move in column down ASR WHISKEY and assault CRASH SITE 3. Platoon will move north along ASR BOURBON and assault CRASH SITE 4. Platoon will return to LZ BROADSWORD for exfil.

(4) **Havoc-1:** Brief squad, perform kit check and radio check. Form file behind Bandit-2. Embark on Buffalo-2 when ordered by Bandit-5, for secondary insert. Havoc-1 will then assault and secure CRASH SITE 2, then plant demo to destroy the wreckage. Havoc-1 will then assault and secure the secondary PRISON buildings. Any POWs will receive MEDEVAC from PRISON. Platoon will move in column down ASR WHISKEY and assault CRASH SITE 3. Platoon will move north along ASR BOURBON and assault CRASH SITE 4. Platoon will return to LZ BROADSWORD for exfil.

(5) **Bandit-4:** Not expected to be filled, lowest priority for slots. To be inserted into LZ MUSKET, escorted by Apollo to friendly forces then await tasking from Bandit-6.

c) Medical Section

(1) **Mustang-1:** Brief squad, perform kit check and radio check. Form file facing towards airframes. Embark on Buffalo-2 when ordered by Bandit-6, for initial insert. Insert into LZ BROADSWORD. Move to RP 1 and provide security to East until second insert complete. Remain attached to Bandit Platoon and attend to any wounded or recovered POWs. When PRISON is secure POWs will receive MEDEVAC from PRISON.

ii. ***Actions at halts (short/long)***. SOP.

iii. ***Routes (primary/alternate)***. ASR WHISKEY, ASR BOURBON.

iv. ***Departure and reentry of friendly lines***. Advise 5th SFG of departure north of phase line green, ensure relay to 3rd Brigade SNSF.

v. ***Rally points and actions at rally points***. **RP-1** (1168-9529) Provide security for LZ BROADSWORD.

vi. ***Actions at danger areas***. SOP.

vii. ***Actions on enemy contact***. Engage. Defend perimeter. Do not chase.

viii. ***Reorganization and consolidation instructions***. Board Buffalo-1 / Buffalo-2, insert @ LZ Musket, Apollo-6 will provide escort to friendly forces.

ix. ***Fire distribution measures.*** SOP.

x. ***Fire control measures***. Engage the greatest threat first. Defend BLUFOR sites and personnel.

xi. ***MOPP levels***. MOPP Ready.

xii. ***Troop safety and operational exposure guidance***. Nuclear radiation may be present around the WMDs. Likelihood of triggering WMDs low, although they may be trapped. Use extreme caution.

xiii. ***Time schedules (rehearsals, backbriefs, inspections, movement)***. TBD.

xiv. ***Priority Intelligence Requirements (PIR)***.

a) Location and disposition of friendly EPWs.

b) OPFOR composition and capabilities.

c) Locations of IEDs, VEIDs, and other ambush sites.

xv. ***Debriefing requirements***. See PIR above.

xvi. ***Reports***. ACE and SALUTE reports after all OPFOR contact, SALUTE upon observation of all OPFOR.

xvii. ***Rules of Engagement (ROE)***. Mission outcome requires limited to known OPFOR contact. Only engage OPFOR in self defense. Avoid prolonged engagement with OPFOR.

IV. Service Support.

A. General.

i. ***SOPs in effect for sustainment operations.*** None.

ii. ***Current and proposed trains/resupply/cache points***. TBD.

iii. ***Casualty and damaged equipment***.

a) CCPs. Prison complex, once secured. If prison complex is not secured, CCPs will be established based on METT-TC.

b) Location of the medevac PZ. Prison complex, once secured. If prison complex is not secured, medevac PZ will be established based on METT-TC.

iv. ***Special instructions for medical personnel***. None. SOP.

B. Material and Services.

i. ***Supply***:

a) Class I: SOP.

b) Class II: SOP.

c) Class III: SOP.

d) Class IV: N/A

e) Class V: SOP.

f) Class VI: N/A.

g) Class VII: SOP.

h) Class VIII: SOP.

i) Class IX: SOP

j) Class X: N/A.

k) Distribution Methods. SOP.

ii. ***Transportation***.

a) Ground. Not available.

b) Air. UH-60M (2-227th AVN)

iii. ***Services***. SOP

iv. ***Maintenance (weapons, equipment, vehicles)***. N/A.

C. **Medical Evacuation**: Casualties need to be treated in field. In event of critical wounded, CASEVAC will be provided by UH-60M (2-227th) from designated PZ back to FOB.

D. **Personnel**:

i. All **reinserts** will be coordinated through S3 Officer in Charge (Apollo) and Aviation Coordinator (Pegasus).

ii. All **EPWs** will be detained, searched, and cleared of all weapons and equipment. They will be transported back to the FOB via UH-60M (2-227th AVN).

E. **Miscellaneous**:

i. ***Special equipment***. None.

ii. ***Captured equipment***. Destroy in place, unless strange or unique. In case of strange or unique, case with or if can't be moved make a sketch and destroy it.

V. **Command & Signal.**

A. Command.

i. HHC 1ABCT is based out of FOB [Classified], Kismayo.

ii. Battalion CP located at FOB Jazeerah, Mogadishu.

iii. ***Succession of Command***.

a) S3 Officer in Charge (Apollo-6)

b) Infantry Platoon Leader (Bandit-6)

c) Infantry Platoon Sergeant (Bandit-7)

d) Aviation Platoon Leader (Pegasus)

iv. ***Adjustments to the unit SOP***. None.

B. Signal

i. ***SOI***. Standard SOI per Battalion.

ii. ***Method of communication by priority***. Short-range radio, Long-range radio, runner.

iii. ***Pyrotechnics and signals***. SOP + SL & up fix IR strobes during CAS

iv. ***Codewords***. None.

v. ***Challenge and password (behind friendly lines)***. Ring / Physics

vi. ***Number combination (forward of friendly lines)***. 3

vii. ***Running password***. Soft.

viii. ***Recognition signals (near/far, day/night)***. Any combination of 3 lasers.

ix. ***Special instructions for RTOs***. None.

AUTHENTICATION

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S3 Officer in Charge